

****20.01.2025****

****Sanction for Violation of GDPR****

The National Authority for the Supervision of Personal Data Processing completed, in December 2024, several investigations into the operator Vodafone Romania S.A. and found a violation of the provisions of art. 32 para. (4) in conjunction with art. 32 para. (1) lit. b of Regulation (EU) 2016/679.

As such, the operator was sanctioned with a fine amounting to 74,526 Lei (equivalent to 15,000 Euro). The investigations were initiated following the operator's transmission of several notifications of personal data security breaches, according to the provisions of art. 33 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, as well as following some complaints.

During the investigations, it was found that, repeatedly, the operator Vodafone Romania S.A. failed to ensure the confidentiality of data belonging to several data subjects, clients of the company (name, surname, email addresses, personal identification number, client code, and client address), as a result of non-compliance with the policies and working procedures regarding the processing of personal data by its employees or authorized persons.

The data security breach was determined by situations such as:

- unauthorized transmission of a photo containing the billing details of a data subject to a third party;
- failure to conceal the email addresses of the recipients and not selecting the "BCC" (blind carbon copy) option when informing data subjects about changes regarding their account manager;
- transmission via WhatsApp by an employee of an authorized person of the operator, of a photograph containing a screenshot with data displayed in the operator's application interface;
- erroneous transmission of a bill belonging to a data subject to a third party.

The incidents led to the disclosure and unauthorized access to the personal data of several data subjects.

Thus, it was found that the operator did not take appropriate technical and organizational measures to ensure that any natural person acting under its authority and having access to personal data processes them only at its request and did not implement appropriate technical and organizational measures to ensure a level of security appropriate to the risk of data processing, including the ability to ensure their confidentiality and integrity.

For these facts, the operator was fined for violating the provisions of art. 32 para. (4) in conjunction with art. 32 para. (1) lit. b) of Regulation (EU) 2016/679.

The operator has paid the established contravention fine.

****Legal and Communication Department****

****N.A.S.P.D.C.P****